

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 3
 ♥ A 8 5 3
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 4 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K 10 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

Board 4

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6
♥ A 8
♦ 10 9 8 5 4
♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A K 9 2
♥ J 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 8 3 2



♠ J 7 5 4
♥ 9 7 4 3 2
♦ J 3
♣ A 6

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q J 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1 ♥. Partner says 1 ♠.

Partner doesn't have 4 ♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.